

Cauliflower-Zucchini White Cheddar Mac & Cheese

SERVES 6
45 MINUTES

Grilled grass-fed sirloin with creamy white cheddar macaroni and two vegetables blended invisibly into the sauce.

Equipment: grill; large pot; steamer or microwave; blender; medium saucepan

GRILLED SIRLOIN

- Grass-fed top sirloin steaks, 6 oz each - **6**
- Avocado oil - **1 tbsp**
- Kosher salt - **1 tsp**
- Black pepper - **1 tsp**

HIDDEN-VEGGIE MAC

- Elbow macaroni, dry - **9 oz**
- Frozen cauliflower - **12 oz (1 bag)**
- Zucchini, peeled and roughly chopped - **2 medium**
- Butter - **2 tbsp**
- All-purpose flour - **2 tbsp**
- 2% milk - **1 cup**
- White cheddar, shredded - **4 1/2 oz (about 1 cup)**
- Kosher salt - **1 tsp, plus pasta water**

METHOD

1. Heat the grill for direct high heat. Peel and roughly chop zucchini (**2 medium**); measure frozen cauliflower (**12 oz**), butter (**2 tbsp**), all-purpose flour (**2 tbsp**), 2% milk (**1 cup**), and shredded white cheddar (**4 1/2 oz**). Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil.
2. Steam or microwave the frozen cauliflower (**12 oz**) and peeled, chopped zucchini (**2 medium**) until very tender, about 8-10 minutes. Blend until completely smooth, adding a small splash from the measured 2% milk (**1 cup total**) only if needed.
3. Pat the grass-fed top sirloin steaks (**6 steaks, 6 oz each**) dry. Rub with avocado oil (**1 tbsp**), kosher salt (**1 tsp**), and black pepper (**1 tsp**). Grill over direct high heat, turning once, until they reach your preferred doneness; for medium-rare, remove at 130-135 F. Rest 5-10 minutes.
4. Cook elbow macaroni (**9 oz dry**) in the salted boiling water until just al dente. Reserve 1/2 cup pasta water, then drain.
5. Melt butter (**2 tbsp**) in a medium saucepan over medium-low heat. Stir in all-purpose flour (**2 tbsp**) and cook for 2 minutes without browning.
6. Gradually whisk in the remaining 2% milk (**from 1 cup total**). Simmer gently until smooth and thickened, 3-4 minutes. Remove from heat and stir in shredded white cheddar (**4 1/2 oz**) and kosher salt (**1 tsp**) until melted.
7. Whisk the blended frozen cauliflower (**12 oz**) and zucchini (**2 medium**) into the white cheddar sauce until completely smooth. Fold in the cooked elbow macaroni (**9 oz dry before cooking**), loosening with reserved pasta water as needed. Serve beside the rested grass-fed top sirloin steaks (**6 steaks**).

SMOOTH SAUCE: Blend the vegetables while hot and add the cheddar off heat to keep the sauce silky.

Revised favorite - one 12 oz cauliflower bag and no onion. Source hash is printed below.